Dhole Patil College of Engineering

First Year of Engineering (2024 Pattern)

Course Code: IKS-151 Course Name: Indian Knowledge System

Assignments for Term Work

Assignment 2

Students should complete the assignment as stated in the Instructions.

Learning Outcome: Enhances research skills and understanding of the historical context.

NOTE: Enhance your presentation by including relevant pictures, diagrams, and illustrations. Make it visually appealing with decorative elements such as borders, color themes and pictures that reflect the cultural and environmental aspects of your project.

Instructions

- Write **3 topics** from the given list
    1. 1 topic from 1 to 4
    2. 1 topic from 5 to 11 &
    3. Topic 12 (compulsory for all)
- Write **each topic separately**
- Use **headings**
- **200 to 400 words per heading**
- Do the write up according to the instructions given after the topics.

Topics:

1. Early and Later Vedic Society and the Varna System — Social organization and its influence on Indian culture. Describe social structure, occupations, and its long-term influence.

2. Transition to the Later Vedic Period — Changes in rituals, kingship, and the rise of large kingdoms (Mahajanapadas). Describe social and political changes, including the rise of kingdoms.

3. The Structure of the society in the Early Vedic Period --- Social organization in the early vedic period. Explain the structure of society before the Later Vedic period.

4. Women Philosophers in the Vedic Period — Female scholars like and their contributions to the vedic discourse

5. Composition of the Rigveda (~1500 BCE) — The earliest Vedic text and its impact on religion and society. Explain its structure, hymns, and impact on religion and society.

6. Compilation of the Other Vedas (Samaveda, Yajurveda, Atharvaveda) — How these texts shaped rituals, chants, and medicine. Highlight their unique roles (chants, rituals, healing practices).

7. The Role of Yajnas (Sacrificial Rituals) — Maintaining cosmic order through ritual practices. How rituals maintained cosmic order and influenced practices.

8. Emergence of Vedanta (Auxiliary Sciences) — Phonetics, grammar, astronomy, and their contributions to knowledge. Explore early fields like linguistics, astronomy, and mathematics.

9. Development of the Upanishads (~800–500 BCE) — The shift from ritualism to spiritual and philosophical inquiry. Explain the shift from rituals to philosophy (Brahman, Atman, Moksha).

10. Concept of Rta (Cosmic Order) — The idea of universal order and its impact on ethics and law. Discuss how this idea influenced ethics, law, and dharma.

11. Philosophical Concepts in the Upanishads — Core ideas like Brahman, Atman, karma, and moksha. Explore key concepts like karma, dharma, and self-realization.

12. The Guru-Shishya Tradition — The oral teaching system and its role in preserving knowledge. Describe the oral learning system and its impact on preserving knowledge.

For each topic, students have to write:

1. Title: Write the exact topic name

2. Introduction (1 short paragraph)
- What is the topic about?
- Which period does it belong to?
- Why is it important?

3. Background / Context
- Historical period
- Social or religious setting
- Related texts or thinkers

4. Explanation (Most important part)
- Explain the **core idea / event / concept**
- Key features or ideas
- Important terms (explain in simple words)
- How it worked or was practiced?

5. Significance
- Why does this topic matter?
- Impact on: Society, Religion, Philosophy / thought, Long-term influence

6. Contribution to Indian Knowledge Systems
- How it helped develop:
  - Philosophy
  - Science / Mathematics
  - Medicine / Health
  - Ethics / Education
- Connection to structured knowledge systems

7. Present-Day Relevance

- Is it still relevant today?
- Influence on modern life, values, or education

8. Conclusion

- 2–3 lines summary
- Why this topic is important overall

9. References

- Minimum **3 sources**
- Books / academic websites / translations

Writing Rules

- Paragraph form (no bullet answers)
- Simple, clear language
- No plagiarism, No copying from others (5 marks will be deducted if found so)
- Proper headings compulsory